IILM UNIVERSITY

CYBERSECURITY SIMULATION

Summary, Key Findings & Learning Outcomes

Deloitte Cyber Job Simulation — Forage

Submitted by	Abhishek Jaiswal
Programme	B.Tech — Computer Science & Engineering
Roll Number	2410031062
Section	3CSE15
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ACADEMIC SUMMARY DOCUMENT

This document summarises the scenario, analysis, conclusions and skills practised during a virtual job simulation. It is not a claim of employment or a formal internship with Deloitte.

1. Executive Summary

The Deloitte Cyber Job Simulation on Forage provided a practical, scenario-based exercise in reviewing web activity logs and assessing whether observed behaviour indicated a possible security concern. The case involved a company dashboard hosted on an internal network after sensitive production information had appeared in a news publication.

The investigation focused on how the dashboard was accessed, how requests appeared in the logs, and whether the observed pattern resembled normal user browsing or automated activity. The main lesson was to base conclusions on the available evidence and distinguish an unusual pattern from proof of a security breach.

Key takeaway: the logs supported the presence of regular automated status checks from an internal network address, but they did not independently establish the identity, intent, or authorisation of the process.

2. Scenario and Investigation Goals

The scenario presented a dashboard that displayed machine-status information. A public news report about sensitive production problems raised concern that the dashboard or its data might have been accessed inappropriately.

The analysis aimed to:

• Determine whether the dashboard appeared to be directly accessible from the public internet.

• Understand what the internal IP addresses and request patterns suggested about access.

• Compare normal browser activity with repeated API requests that might be automated.

• Summarise findings carefully without claiming more than the logs could prove.

3. Analysis Approach

The review compared the sequence and frequency of requests, the resources requested, and the network addresses recorded in the logs. A typical interactive visit would generally include a login, requests for dashboard page resources, and API calls to retrieve machine-status information. The suspicious pattern consisted of repeated, regularly timed API status checks without the surrounding page-resource requests expected during ordinary dashboard browsing.

Evidence reviewed	Interpretation
Private 192.168.0.x addresses in recorded requests	Consistent with traffic originating within a private network; not, by itself, proof of who generated it.
Dashboard described as intranet-hosted	Supports the conclusion that direct public-internet access was not the intended access path.
Regular hourly API status checks without page assets	Suggests an automated or scripted process rather than a person repeatedly loading the dashboard.
Normal sequence includes login, page resources and API requests	Provides a baseline against which the repeated API-only pattern can be compared.

4. Key Findings

Network access: The scenario described the dashboard as hosted on the company intranet. The private 192.168.0.x addresses in the logs were consistent with internal-network activity. Remote access was expected to occur through a VPN tunnel into the private network, rather than through direct public access.

Request pattern: The most notable automated-looking behaviour was a regular series of hourly API requests checking machine status, without requests for the dashboard's page resources.

Dashboard updates: The scenario indicated that the dashboard did not continuously push or poll for updates; users needed to refresh it to see updated information. This made the repeated, periodic API checks worth investigating.

Overall interpretation: The pattern was consistent with a process querying status data from inside the network. The evidence did not conclusively identify the process, establish whether it was authorised, or prove that data had been exfiltrated.

5. Learning Outcomes

Skill area	What was practised
Log analysis	Compared request sequences and frequency to identify behaviour that differed from typical browser use.
Networking fundamentals	Practised interpreting private IP addresses, intranet access and VPN-based remote access.
Web application behaviour	Distinguished page-resource requests from API calls used to retrieve application data.
Evidence-based reasoning	Learned to describe what logs support, what remains uncertain, and what additional evidence would be needed.
Security communication	Practised presenting findings in clear language without overstating the severity or certainty of an incident.

6. Recommended Follow-up Checks

If this were a live investigation, useful next steps would include validating the source host and account, checking whether the process was approved, correlating timestamps with authentication and VPN logs, reviewing API permissions and access records, and checking whether the queried data was stored or transferred elsewhere. These are recommended follow-up actions, not findings established by the simulation.

7. Reflection and Conclusion

This simulation demonstrated that a security analyst must examine both the technical pattern and the limits of the available evidence. A repeated API request can be a useful indicator of automation, but automation is not automatically malicious. Context, authorisation, source identity and corroborating records are needed before assigning intent or confirming a breach.

The exercise strengthened my understanding of web request patterns, internal networking concepts and structured security reasoning. It also reinforced the importance of recording observations separately from interpretations and clearly stating uncertainty in an incident summary.

In conclusion, the activity provided introductory, practical exposure to cybersecurity log analysis. The principal outcome was learning how to identify an unusual request pattern, explain why it deserves review, and recommend proportionate follow-up checks while avoiding unsupported claims.

8. Skills Summary

Technical concepts	Practical application
Private IP addressing and intranet access	Used network context to assess the likely location of recorded requests.
VPN access	Understood the intended route for remote users to enter a private network.
HTTP/API request patterns	Compared routine page loading with periodic API-only requests.
Analytical reporting	Summarised observations, interpretations, limitations and next steps.

9. Reference and Scope

Primary activity: Deloitte Cyber Job Simulation on Forage, completed on 22 October 2026. This summary reflects the scenario and analysis tasks completed in the simulation. It is a learning-outcomes document, not a forensic report about a real confirmed incident and not evidence of employment or a formal internship with Deloitte.

Prepared by: Abhishek Jaiswal | B.Tech Computer Science & Engineering | Roll No. 2410031062 | Section 3CSE15